# 반말 ↔ 존댓말: 언제, 어떻게 바꿔 말해요?

This worksheet shows how to change everyday sentences between 반말 and 해요 style.

**WHAT THIS IS FOR**

By the end, you can change short everyday sentences from 반말 to 해요 style and back, and tell who suggested switching to 반말.

## 1 WHY SWITCHING MATTERS

In English, you can sound polite by adding "please" or "sir." In Korean, the ending of almost every sentence changes, and so do small words like "I," "you," and "yes." Switching is a sign of how close two people are, not just grammar.

Don't switch to 반말 on your own. Wait until the other person offers. Usually the older person or the one with the higher position offers first. If you are not sure, 해요 is always the safe choice.

## 2 말 놓기: FROM 존댓말 TO 반말

1. **처음 만남: 존댓말** (first meeting: polite speech)
2. **나이 묻기: "몇 년생이세요?"** (asking someone's age or birth year)
3. **제안하기: "말 편하게 하세요"** (offering to drop formal speech)
4. **대답하기: "네, 그럴까요?"** (agreeing to the offer)
5. **반말 쓰기: "그럼 이제 친구"** (starting to use 반말)

## 3 SWITCH IT: 반말 → 해요

1. **응 → 네** (yes)
   Use 응 only with close people. Use 네 with anyone you speak to politely.
   예: 응, 갈게. → 네, 갈게요.
2. **아니 → 아니요** (no)
   아니 alone sounds casual. Add 요 when you are being polite.
   예: 아니, 안 바빠. → 아니요, 안 바빠요.
3. **나 / 내가 → 저 / 제가** (I)
   In polite speech, use the humble word for yourself.
   예: 내가 할게. → 제가 할게요.
4. **너 → 이름 + 씨 / 직함** (you)
   Polite speech avoids a word for "you." Use the person's name with 씨, or their title.
   예: 너도 와? → 민수 씨도 와요?
5. **-아/어 → -아요/어요** (statement / question ending)
   Add 요 to the casual ending.
   예: 지금 바빠? → 지금 바빠요?
6. **-야/이야 → -예요/이에요** ("it is" ending)
   After a noun, change 야/이야 to 예요/이에요.
   예: 내일이 시험이야. → 내일이 시험이에요.
7. **-자 → -아요/어요, -(으)ㄹ까요?** ("let's" ending)
   A polite suggestion uses -아요/어요, or the softer -(으)ㄹ까요?
   예: 같이 먹자. → 같이 먹어요. (먹을까요?)



Copyright © 2026 DURU KOREAN. All rights reserved.
For personal and educational use only. Commercial use, redistribution, or reproduction without the author's permission is prohibited.

8 **-아/어 줘 → -아/어 주세요** (request ending)
For a request, change 줘 to 주세요.
예: 문 좀 열어 줘. → 문 좀 열어 주세요.

Polite speech on this sheet means the 해요 style, the one most often used in daily life.

## 4 YOUR TURN

### SWITCH THE SPEECH STYLE

Read each situation, then rewrite, choose, fill in, or answer as each question asks.

1. Change to polite 해요 style (to a coworker):
①나 지금 집에 가.
②이거 누구 거야?

2. Change to 반말 (to a close friend):
①내일 시간 있어요?
②제가 커피 살게요.

3. Read the chat and answer in English. Who is older, and who suggested using 반말? — 지수: 민호 씨, 몇 년생이에요? / 민호: 98년생이에요. / 지수: 아, 저는 96년생이에요. 말 편하게 해도 돼요? / 민호: 네, 그럼요. / 지수: 고마워, 민호야!

4. Fill in the blanks with the right words for "you" and "my" (talking to a coworker named 지영): ____도 같이 갈래요? ____ 차로 가요.

5. Rewrite politely (to an older coworker):
①우리 여기서 좀 쉬자.
②그 파일 좀 보내 줘.
③아니, 안 추워.

## ANSWERS

1) ① 저 지금 집에 가요. ② 이거 누구 거예요?
2) ① 내일 시간 있어? ② 내가 커피 살게.
3) 지수 is older (born in '96; 민호 was born in '98). 지수 suggested it.
4) 지영 씨 / 제
5) ① (우리) 여기서 좀 쉬어요. / (우리) 여기서 좀 쉴까요? ② 그 파일 좀 보내 주세요. ③ 아니요, 안 추워요.



Copyright © 2026 DURU KOREAN. All rights reserved.
For personal and educational use only. Commercial use, redistribution, or reproduction without the author's permission is prohibited.